APMA 3140-001 **App Partial Differentl Equatns** - Fall 2014

ENGR (17540)

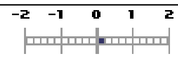
INSTRUCTORS: **Johnson, Ryan (rfj2c)**

Respondents: 64 / Enrollment: 65

Summary: APMA 3140-001 App Partial Differentl Equatns - Fall 2014 (17540)

Overall Course Rating

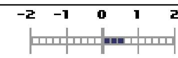
APMA-3140-001 Mean 4.26
APMA-3140-001 Std Dev 1.01
APMA-3140-001 Response Count 320

Difference from Category Mean, Expressed in Category Standard Deviations	 0.17

SEAS, 3000-level courses Mean 4.09
SEAS, 3000-level courses Std Dev 0.96
SEAS, 3000-level courses Response Count 10192

Overall Instructor Rating

INSTRUCTOR: Johnson, Ryan
Mean 4.74
Std Dev 0.55
Response Count 446

Difference from Category Mean, Expressed in Category Standard Deviations	 0.58

SEAS, 3000-level courses Mean 4.20
SEAS, 3000-level courses Std Dev 0.92
SEAS, 3000-level courses Response Count 16510

~ QUESTIONS AND DETAILS ~ | *~ ANSWER MATRICES ~*

1. The course addressed technically rigorous subject matter consistent with the course objectives.

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Question Type: Likert
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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	4.69	0.56	46 (71.88%)	17 (26.56%)	0 (0.00%)	1 (1.56%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2037	4.41	0.72	1031 (50.61%)	845 (41.48%)	97 (4.76%)	27 (1.33%)	16 (0.79%)	21 (1.03%)

2. The instructor used methods other than/in addition to traditional lectures (for example, active learning, in-class problems, collaborative learning, in-class discussion) effectively in this course.

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Question Type: Likert
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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
63	4.76	0.53	51 (80.95%)	9 (14.29%)	3 (4.76%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2365	3.96	1.05	824 (34.84%)	874 (36.96%)	335 (14.16%)	191 (8.08%)	69 (2.92%)	72 (3.04%)

3. There was a reasonable level of effort expected for the credit hours received.

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Question Type: Likert
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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	4.58	0.71	43 (67.19%)	17 (26.56%)	2 (3.12%)	2 (3.12%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2043	4.14	0.95	828 (40.53%)	864 (42.29%)	185 (9.06%)	106 (5.19%)	49 (2.40%)	11 (0.54%)

~ QUESTIONS AND DETAILS ~	~ ANSWER MATRICES ~

4. The homework assignments helped me learn the subject matter.
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Question Type: Likert
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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	4.72	0.60	50 (78.12%)	11 (17.19%)	2 (3.12%)	1 (1.56%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2039	4.23	0.88	861 (42.23%)	794 (38.94%)	174 (8.53%)	79 (3.87%)	29 (1.42%)	102 (5.00%)

5. The textbook increased my understanding of the material.
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Question Type: Likert
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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	3.20	1.23	11 (17.19%)	11 (17.19%)	23 (35.94%)	7 (10.94%)	7 (10.94%)	5 (7.81%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2038	3.62	1.13	392 (19.23%)	592 (29.05%)	363 (17.81%)	183 (8.98%)	91 (4.47%)	417 (20.46%)

6. The course material was well organized and developed.
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Question Type: Likert
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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	4.66	0.67	47 (73.44%)	14 (21.88%)	1 (1.56%)	2 (3.12%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2358	4.08	0.98	883 (37.45%)	981 (41.60%)	239 (10.14%)	145 (6.15%)	58 (2.46%)	52 (2.21%)

7. The instructor was knowledgeable about the subject matter.
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Question Type: Likert
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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	4.89	0.31	57 (89.06%)	7 (10.94%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2356	4.57	0.66	1460 (61.97%)	721 (30.60%)	76 (3.23%)	28 (1.19%)	10 (0.42%)	61 (2.59%)

8. The instructor was well prepared for class.
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Question Type: Likert
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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	4.80	0.57	55 (85.94%)	6 (9.38%)	2 (3.12%)	1 (1.56%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2352	4.30	0.89	1144 (48.64%)	853 (36.27%)	184 (7.82%)	66 (2.81%)	47 (2.00%)	58 (2.47%)

~ QUESTIONS AND DETAILS ~	*~ ANSWER MATRICES ~*

9. I received adequate preparation from the prior courses in the curriculum to be successful in this course.

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Question Type: Likert

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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	4.02	0.97	25 (39.06%)	20 (31.25%)	14 (21.88%)	5 (7.81%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2035	3.97	0.94	609 (29.93%)	842 (41.38%)	315 (15.48%)	132 (6.49%)	29 (1.43%)	108 (5.31%)

10. The grading policy was fair.

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Question Type: Likert

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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
63	4.62	0.66	44 (69.84%)	15 (23.81%)	3 (4.76%)	1 (1.59%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2364	4.12	0.92	884 (37.39%)	990 (41.88%)	276 (11.68%)	103 (4.36%)	44 (1.86%)	67 (2.83%)

11. The instructor responded adequately to in-class questions.

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Question Type: Likert

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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	4.73	0.45	47 (73.44%)	17 (26.56%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2357	4.29	0.83	1076 (45.65%)	929 (39.41%)	187 (7.93%)	68 (2.89%)	27 (1.15%)	70 (2.97%)

12. The instructor effectively used technology in support of the learning goals for this course.

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Question Type: Likert

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contributed by Dean of the School of Engineering and Applied Science

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
64	4.69	0.59	47 (73.44%)	15 (23.44%)	1 (1.56%)	1 (1.56%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)	Not Applicable (NA)
2358	4.08	0.95	844 (35.79%)	958 (40.63%)	285 (12.09%)	121 (5.13%)	48 (2.04%)	102 (4.33%)

13. The average number of hours per week I spent outside of class preparing for this course was:

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Question Type: Multiple Choice

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contributed by Office of the Provost

Results for APMA-3140-001

Total	Less than 1 (NA)	1 - 3 (NA)	4 - 6 (NA)	7 - 9 (NA)	10 or more (NA)
64	0 (0.00%)	9 (14.06%)	29 (45.31%)	25 (39.06%)	1 (1.56%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Less than 1 (NA)	1 - 3 (NA)	4 - 6 (NA)	7 - 9 (NA)	10 or more (NA)
2044	111 (5.43%)	552 (27.01%)	825 (40.36%)	354 (17.32%)	202 (9.88%)

~ QUESTIONS AND DETAILS ~	~ ANSWER MATRICES ~

14. I learned a great deal in this course.
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Question Type: Likert
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contributed by Office of the Provost

Results for APMA-3140-001

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
64	4.62	0.63	45 (70.31%)	14 (21.88%)	5 (7.81%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
2036	4.18	0.89	847 (41.60%)	853 (41.90%)	220 (10.81%)	90 (4.42%)	26 (1.28%)

15. Overall, this was a worthwhile course.
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Question Type: Likert
~
contributed by Office of the Provost

Results for APMA-3140-001

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
64	4.62	0.68	46 (71.88%)	13 (20.31%)	4 (6.25%)	1 (1.56%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
2041	4.11	1.00	864 (42.33%)	766 (37.53%)	243 (11.91%)	113 (5.54%)	55 (2.69%)

16. The course's goals and requirements were defined and adhered to by the instructor.
~
Question Type: Likert
~
contributed by Office of the Provost

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
63	4.71	0.52	47 (74.60%)	14 (22.22%)	2 (3.17%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
2360	4.29	0.76	1015 (43.01%)	1104 (46.78%)	172 (7.29%)	47 (1.99%)	22 (0.93%)

17. The instructor was approachable and made himself/herself available to students outside the classroom.
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Question Type: Likert
~
contributed by Office of the Provost

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
63	4.81	0.43	52 (82.54%)	10 (15.87%)	1 (1.59%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
2358	4.28	0.83	1105 (46.86%)	900 (38.17%)	271 (11.49%)	62 (2.63%)	20 (0.85%)

18. Overall, the instructor was an effective teacher.
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Question Type: Likert
~
contributed by Office of the Provost

Results for APMA-3140-001, Johnson, Ryan

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
64	4.81	0.64	57 (89.06%)	4 (6.25%)	2 (3.12%)	0 (0.00%)	1 (1.56%)

Results for SEAS, 3000-level courses

Total	Mean	Std Dev	Strongly Agree (5)	Agree (4)	Neutral (3)	Disagree (2)	Strongly Disagree (1)
2370	4.17	0.97	1063 (44.85%)	874 (36.88%)	257 (10.84%)	118 (4.98%)	58 (2.45%)

~ QUESTIONS AND DETAILS ~	~ ANSWER MATRICES ~
19. Please make any overall comments or observations about this course: ~ Question Type: Short Answer ~ *contributed by Office of the Provost*	Results for APMA-3140-001

Total	Individual Answers
49	*See below for Individual Results*

Wish professor had more office hours instead of other people, as I could not make it to his office hours and the office hours I went to often ended up confusing me and lowering my grade substantially. Also the homework was very redundant and annoying, to the point where it was not even useful.

The layout of the curriculum and the timeline in which it was laid out was extremely helpful. We started with tools for solving PDEs, which made each successive section much easier to understand

Great professor. Handbook was really well done, and the homework hit critical points that reinforced my understanding of the material. Glad to make this my final math course at UVA.

This class was extremely valuable, and I really like the current layout of the class. The handbook written by Dr. Johnson was so, so helpful in the understanding of the material, and he constantly had either himself or a colleague available for homework help, which I feel is almost a necessity in this course.

Dr. J is one of those unique individuals who is exceptional at teaching. Unlike many professors, he is able to convey complex topics by discussing with the class and relating issues he has noticed and experienced personally. Only critique of the course was the class size restricted Dr. J from discussing more advanced topics (which he was dying to do!). Overall, one of the best teachers I have had at UVa.

Ryan's been the best instructor I've had while at UVa. He held a ton of office hours for the students that needed help, he would respond very quickly to e-mails, and was very approachable. Furthermore, he went as far as to right his own textbook for the class while writing his dissertation. His textbook was an amazing resource, covering topics in a much more understandable, entry level manner. That's not to say that the material was not hard, it was just that his textbook was much easier to understand than most textbooks on PDEs available. Definitely, whoever teaches this class next year, use Ryan's textbook. His methodology throughout the entire class was excellent. He introduced us to the basic tools that we needed for the first month. While at the time everyone was wondering what the application was of all of these fundamentals that we were learning, they became very clear once we started solving PDEs. The next instructor should definitely take this approach, as I feel a lot of students will be left behind and intimidated and want to drop out of the most interesting math classes available if the instructor does not follow Ryan's teaching method. Ryan also did problems similar to those on the homework during class. The time to solve a non-homogeneous PDE with non-homogeneous boundary conditions can very easily take well over 20 minutes to do by hand, so when Ryan did some of the homework problems in class, it really helped to see what we should do if we get stuck, the methods to take, etc. The MatLab assignments definitely helped to visualize and understand what our solutions were doing. Furthermore, Ryan related to his students very well, he took the time to learn pretty much everyone's name, he understood the effects of extraneous activities (i.e. death of two student, Hannah) on students and he openly discussed the importance of not drowning yourself in the stress that is schoolwork and tests and projects. The fact that he was so relatable (not to mention knowledgeable) made students want to come to his class, to ask questions, to be curious. So definitely, for the next instructor, listen to what Ryan says about this class, grab his materials and follow in his footsteps. He made learning fun again. It's sad to know that Ryan won't be around teaching anymore, but I wish him the best at the lab that he is going to, I know you'll do awesome work. :)

The best overall instruction in an elevated course I've had at the University.

The Handbook Mr. Johnson wrote for us was a phenomenal resource. Mr. Johnson was a very effective instructor.

-Ryan is extremely knowledgable about what he teaches -The handbook he wrote was the best resource for this class. It explained all the concepts in simple easy-to-understand terms unlike most textbooks

Dr. Johnson went above and beyond what was necessary for this class. He wrote a handbook that specifically taught the material in a very effective manner, he was always available outside of class, and overall a great teacher.

This was by far one of the most intense, but rewarding, classes I have taken at the University. I learned more in this class than probably all of my other courses thus far (other than Dojo's classes). Whoever is teaching this course in the future NEEDS to use Ryan's material, because it is extremely effective. We were challenged, but we excelled because of Ryan. Use his freaking material!! That is all.

Dr. Ryan and the TA's were always available and in communication with us. Grading policy was more than fair. I was frustrated at times with the handbook because when some derivation didn't make sense to me I wasn't sure if it was the textbook or me (despite looking over the math again and again). Haberman was very removed from our class. I gave Ryan a really hard time and he was very nice about it. 10/10 would take again.

The use of MATLAB was great. Made it easy to learn and did a great job showing the application. The handbook was great and much more helpful than the actual textbook.

~ QUESTIONS AND DETAILS ~	~ ANSWER MATRICES ~
	Ryan Johnson is by far one of the best examples of a great professor. His handbook helped students to learn the materials by using straightforward examples and casual speech. Students also had the opportunity to edit the handbook to better convey the materials. Instead of spending a lot of time trying to decipher through round-about wordings in standard textbooks, students can read through the chapters in the handbook to help with their assignments. It is a great resource that should be preserved for the future students of this course. Office hours were very well organized throughout the week so that students can come for help. The professor was extremely knowledgeable in the subject and approachable. Overall, it was a great class because of the way it was taught. Thank you for a great PDE semester, Ryan. You are one of the few professors that can make a math class fun and educational. See ya later, Dr. Johnson :D
	My answer to Question 5 refers to the course textbook written by Richard Haberman and not to the handbook written by Ryan Johnson. Although our instructor specified that Haberman was really more of a good reference material than a textbook, the one time I tried to use it to understand what we were doing in class better, I couldn't find the topic in the book. The handbook written by Johnson was super helpful and that should definitely be the book for the course rather than Haberman. Johnson's approach to the course (learning eigenvalues and eigenfunctions first before even touching any PDEs) is definitely why I was successful in this course. I know that if we had tried to solve PDEs without first learning the different eigenvalues and eigenfunctions, I would not have performed well in the course nor understand what was going on. So both the handbook he made and his approach to the course should definitely be used in future years. An administrative problem I had with the course, since Johnson did not choose the time and days of the course, is that Aerospace Engineering schedules were not considered when scheduling the course. Aerospace Engineers are the only major REQUIRED to take this course so their schedules MUST be considered. We had 2 classes that are 1 hour and 15 minutes each before this course, without a break, so by the time I got to class I was a little burnt out from those two courses as well as hungry because there isn't enough time to get food, let alone eat it. Bringing food is not really an option because we have a 9:30 class and some food would go bad by then. Basically: please give us a break between those two courses and this one! It isn't fair to the students or the instructor when students are burnt out / exhausted from two courses before it. Maybe make it a MWF class or make it 2-3:15 instead of 12:30-1:45. Don't punish Aerospace Engineering majors by putting this as the third course in a row (after Aerospace Materials and Fluid Dynamics 1). I learned a lot. It's scary how much I learned. I liked this class even though it was a lot of work. Johnson did good.
	I didn't like having to take the course because I'm not a math major and kind of suck at math, but the instructor taught the class really well and made me feel like this course was worthwhile.
	Ryan had a great understanding of PDEs and was definitely concerned about making sure students were learning them. I never needed the textbook, but the handbook did an extraordinary job of complementing Ryan's lectures. The course's pace was just right, sometimes fast sometimes slow, but overall conducive to learning the material. His attitude about the course was one of putting the students before himself, even amidst working on a PhD.
	Good prof.
	Great instructor, and straightforward materials. Your handbook should come with example problems to reinforce the material.
	I think the combination of the Handbook Ryan wrote along with his lectures and homework assignments were extremely effective. I do think the practice exams were also extremely helpful in helping us identify our weaknesses before exams. Ryan included a broad range of material covered in varying depths but I like how he showed us some cool things towards the end as well that were not to be tested on. Overall my favorite APMA class; unlike other APMA classes where it almost felt as if each exam was more targeted to tripping you up rather than testing what you've learned, this class not only helped me learn the material fully but also helped me show it on tests. And the handbook was an absolutely phenomenal resource that guided our thinking during learning the material in exactly the direction it needed to rather than as in most APMA classes feeling somewhat or wholly lost right up until (and in many cases during) the tests.
	Ryan Johnson did a fantastic job teaching this class. He made the material very interesting and did a great job explaining the applications of the material. I loved going to class. His handbook was a fantastic tool to learn the material, it was easily understandable. The pace of the class was also a perfect speed. The class atmosphere was also discussion oriented and interactive and much less of the teacher standing and teaching. This is definitely one of the best taught applied math classes I have taken at the University. Ryan Johnson also made himself very available and had multiple office hours at convenient times. He also made himself available outside of office hours. I do not think that he could of done a better job at teaching this class.
	The handbook is the best thing ever.
	He was amazing. Go Ryan! :)
	May be need more explicit use of resources could be helpful and more feed backs? in terms of quizzes? I know grading is a lot...
	Having the MATLAB components of the homework was an excellent idea. It helped students get better at MATLAB and understand how it works in addition to seeing the applications of the subject material. It was nice that we didn't have to write very complicated scripts but only had to edit the relevant parts for us. However I would have liked to understand a little more from some of the scripts that were written for us. This is because although MATLAB is very important for us engineers there isn't a course that really helps us learn it
	The handbook was a great resource. He was passionate about the subject and class. Very good teacher

~ QUESTIONS AND DETAILS ~	~ ANSWER MATRICES ~

great professor and great course. didn't use textbook much. Ryan created a handbook that was very useful and helped tremendously when going over material and using something for reference when doing homework. Would definitely recommend providing to future years for use. Really enjoyed getting to learn and use matlab in class to demonstrate the problems we were doing and give them visualization. This is a hard course and it takes a lot to keep up especially with the other courses that are required during Aero 3rd year. Would recommend, if possible to split the course up into 2 parts or somehow make it so that missing one topic doesn't screw you up for the rest of the course. Sometimes it was hard to go to office hours with the abundance of homework and requirements of other courses. Ryan made himself very available and that helped significantly especially towards the end of the year when problems got more and more complicated. He held 4 office hours per week. I think this system should be required of other teachers because sometimes the time they give is not always convenient and/or conflicts with class or other office hour slots. Would highly recommend using Ryan's course structure and materials as guidelines for future PDE courses and for other courses in the E-school. Above all else, the course was hard but Ryan provided a great framework to guide you through the material. Sometimes hard to keep up. Hard but fair.

Great course, hard but fun. Handbook is extremely helpful

The only thing I didn't like in this class is the fact that we lost points on our homeworks for "neatness". All of the work can be right and you still lose 1/6th of the points for no reason. The homework should be graded on completion or correctness, not neatness. Some people have bad handwriting, its not on purpose, it just is what it is, we shouldn't be penalized for it. On the positive side, the handbook that Ryan made is excellent and extremely helpful in understanding and learning the course material.

Great class! I learned a lot and the handbook was extremely helpful.

Ryan's handbook is awesome

From what I'd heard about PDEs from people at other universities, I expected a grueling, horrible class. But Mr. J took all that and turned it into easily the most fun class I've taken at UVA. His textbook and lectures make the material much easier to understand than the existing textbook (not going to lie, I haven't even touched the Haberman text since the first week after realizing how much better Mr. J's material was). It's truly a loss to the university that future students will not be able to have Mr. J for PDEs. That being said, the textbook that Mr. J has been writing can be used by other professors. If the next instructor follows Mr. J's syllabus and uses his material, they will be able to keep the up the sterling reputation of APMA 3140. As a 4th year, this class is a technical elective for me; I would never have taken it if I hadn't known Mr. J's reputation as a fabulous professor with an excellent approach to PDEs. By using the beginning of the semester to first teach us a "toolkit" of material from ODE concepts through some basic PDE equations, Mr. J set us up for success. Many students including myself hadn't taken an APMA course for several semesters which would have otherwise made leaping into PDEs very difficult. I can't even imagine the number of hours Mr. J put into preparing for this course, answering questions at all hours, and meeting with students. He put his heart and soul into this class and it really showed. Students can tell whether a professor is invested in a course, and when they are, the students themselves become more passionate about learning. Best of luck to you, Ryan/Dr. J/ Mr. J at your new job, but you will be sorely missed.

This was one of the most interesting and well taught courses I have ever taken. Ryan Johnson is one of the best, and possibly the best, instructor I have had at UVa. His knowledge of the subject and enthusiasm in class made it much easier to learn course content that would have otherwise been very difficult to understand. He made himself available for questions and discussion extremely often, and the resources he provided were extremely helpful, especially his self-written handbook. Prof. Johnson helped me develop a deep interest in applied math and influenced my decision to become an applied math minor. I would suggest to any future teacher of this course to utilize all the material and resources Prof. Johnson has to offer (especially his handbook), and I would highly recommend getting him to teach at UVa again as soon as possible.

This is one of the best classes I have taken at UVa, and 99% of this can be attributed to Ryan Johnson as our teacher. Quite honestly, I would argue that he is the best teacher I have had. Ever. He is so quick to respond to any question students have, including emails. He has worked so hard this semester, and between teaching this class and his dissertation, his work has been phenomenal. The handbook he wrote for this class has been my primary resource. It is very clearly written and extremely helpful, and I would easily recommend it over any textbook. His classroom had a very casual and relaxed feel, so I had no problems asking him questions in or out of class (as a generally shy person, I do not often do this). He is very approachable. When I consider how complex the concepts of this class are, I am amazed at how well I understand them thanks to RJ's teaching and resources. There's really no way for me to convey how amazing RJ has been for this class and how much of an incredibly good experience this class has been. It's a shame RJ was only able to teach this class for a couple semesters, but I know he is off to do great things. Hats off to Ryan Johnson.

Dr. Johnson is one of the best professors I have had at UVA. He cares about his students, is knowledgeable about the subject matter, approachable, fair and funny. I love PDEs because he helped me learn the material and used in class examples to help with home work. He was very clear about what material I would be learning and what would be on the test. Showing up for class is the best way to do well in the class because Dr. Johnson wants his students to succeed and takes class time to go over difficult information on tests and home works. His Handbook is like the bible. I never looked at the class textbook because the handbook was so helpful and followed the schedule of the material to be learned in the class. I wish there were more professors like Dr. Johnson and I am sad to know he is leaving. I feel bad for the students who will not have him to teach PDEs. UVA should hire more professor like Dr. Johnson. Students would understand the material in their classes much better.

In question 5, by textbook, I mean Ryan's Handbook for the course. It's great.

~ QUESTIONS AND DETAILS ~ | ~ ANSWER MATRICES ~

Ryan was an incredible teacher. I am a 4th year mathematics major and Ryan is probably the best teacher I have had out of all my math classes. His handbook was much very clear and I hope that the next teacher will continue to use it. Although the grades may be high, I think most students learned more in this class, than a typical class. By the end of the semester we could solve 2-D PDEs with 4 non-homogeneous boundary conditions. Other teachers should learn from Ryan's teaching style, as the class never seemed overwhelming even though we were moving at a solid pace. I did not think the matlab was absolutely necessary, however the final project where we solved a non-linear PDE and simulated a physical system of hotplates interacting with coolants was a great way to wrap up everything we learned. I would recommend make this project due earlier as the week before exams can be stressful. I don't know who reads this, but thank you Ryan and best of luck with the new job!

Awesome class. Ryan is leaving but future class instructors should try talk to him because he is an amazing teacher.

This was a fantastic course. Ryan Johnson made the material approachable and interesting. This was the best APMA course I have taken here.

Ryan was the best instructor I have had at UVa. He was a good lecturer, but what really set him apart was how much time he put into our education. He wrote his own Handbook, which was fantastic, to supplement the textbook. He was almost always available either to meet or talk by email. He wrote a bunch of Matlab to create a project for us to show how what we've been learning is used in the real world. He made this course seem like the most straightforward and easy to understand math course I've taken. Also, he was very approachable. He made it clear that he understood us as students and what we were going through, and that he really cared for us. I wish that he was staying here at least until I graduate, so that I could just take math courses from him and learn some of the vast amount of knowledge he knows.

It was my absolute and utmost pleasure to be a part of Ryan's class this semester. The class was well -organized and important concepts were reiterated appropriately. In addition, the supplemental material in class was fun and engaged me in a subject I was not expecting to be so interested in. The Matlab portion of the class was indeed informative and useful for future coursework, I think. The handbook was also an invaluable resource that succinctly and directly presented relevant course material. It was clear that Ryan put a lot of effort into the class even with his surely busy schedule. Ryan is not only an intelligent individual who passionately and graciously shares his enthusiasm with everyone he meets; he is also a great advocate for his community and I've been thoroughly impressed by his unwavering commitment to social change where he sees fit. He is an impassioned speaker among so many who haven't quite found their voices yet. Ryan, please know that you have definitely reached this student.   (Sorry for the dissertation of a response, but I mean what I say!!)

Ryan Johnson was an exceptional teacher for this course. I strongly benefited from the student handbook he wrote which helped organize and reinforce the material in an understandable way. I think he took the perfect approach in teaching the material in terms of the chronological order in which it was taught. He also balanced the lectures nicely with teacher instruction and practice problems. Overall I actually very much enjoyed this course; it was a class that I looked forward to attending and enjoyed being in. I know Dr. Johnson can't stay at UVA to teach it again, but I strongly recommend the next instructor to adhere to Mr. Johnson's methods, utilize the handbook, and reassign the final project because it was a really good application of what we learned.

I have no idea how a class that started so well ended up turning into such a mess. Why did I even go to class after the first midterm? I thought we were taking PDE, not listening to rants. Seriously, if it wasn't for the handbook (which, I admit, is quite good), I'd have learned absolutely nothing besides a refresh of ODE. He's a good guy, and I know this is his first time teaching solo, but I felt like the test subject of an experiment. Real shame because the content of the course is super fascinating.   Also, the homework. Look, I don't have time to go to office hours regularly, it's just not possible with this semester's loads. That shouldn't be the only way to find out if I did something wrong. An answer key could have saved a number of headaches when a small mistake was made. But it doesn't matter, I'd lose a bunch of points for neatness and full credit for those small mistakes. Brutal grading with homework that doesn't really help until after the solutions are released? Nice... Speaking of neatness...my handwriting and my peers' handwriting is still more legible than the notes in class. I wish we still got copies of class notes like we did during the start of the semester. That was at least a little easier to read.   I know he's well liked (and rightfully so, he's a good person), so this might be the only bad feedback here. But, it's an honest evaluation from the point of view of an academic masochist who learns best secluded. Class was a serious waste of time (unless you came for the humor). It's just a good thing the grading outside the homework was fair and that the content was not too bad.   Also, lighten up on the spam, please? Copperheads are freakin' cool.
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Good class!

Really awesome teacher of the material. Knew his stuff, and his handbook was incredible. Really knew how to help his students understand the material.

Fantastic course, going to miss Prof Johnson.

Ryan is a great teacher and really cares about making his class interesting and challenging for his students. He is incredibly smart and good at PDEs, and can also talk incredibly fast and get really excited leading to parts of the lectures where he blows through material much faster than I would like. However, he is very much self aware of this and actively tries to slow down and make sure everyone is on the same page. The handbook that he wrote for the course was very well written and much appreciated. I never even had to use the regular textbook. Ryan has told us that he'll be leaving UVa and won't be teaching next year, and that the APMA department will have to find a replacement. This will definitely be a challenge, but I think it can be done if the next Professor uses the materials that Ryan is leaving behind. The handbook is incredibly useful and the course outline that Ryan used was intuitive and well thought out. The MATLAB portion of the course felt shoehorned in, but Ryan's approach to it was to treat it as 'MATLAB 101'. He wrote out explicit instructions for each assignment and helped us all the way through, which made my first experience with MATLAB quite painless. Overall, I have no regrets taking this course and I was thoroughly pleased with Ryan's instruction.

~ QUESTIONS AND DETAILS ~	~ ANSWER MATRICES ~
	The handbook was an immense help. UVa is losing an awesome professor by not keeping Ryan Johnson. He is super cool and understands the both the material and the struggle of students and their workload. Also his handbook is amazing. I would not have learned as much as I did without the reinforcement of his book. That should be read by all engineers who are taking this class.